

Organizational Change Leadership Plan - Kotter 8-Step Model

Staff MFA and Identity Security Rollout

Organizational Change Leadership Plan: Staff MFA Rollout

Framework: Kotter's 8-Step Process for Leading Change

Leadership question: How do we make MFA a normal district practice rather than a one-time technical rollout?

1. Create a Sense of Urgency

Case for change: Password-only access leaves staff accounts vulnerable when credentials are phished or reused. Identity security affects learning continuity, payroll, communications, student records, and public trust.

Evidence to use: Internal account-compromise trends, cyber-insurance expectations, peer-district incidents, and results from the district's risk review. Use only information appropriate for the intended audience.

Leadership action: Sponsor and CTO present the change as a district operational priority, not an optional IT preference.

2. Build a Guiding Coalition

Coalition Member	Contribution
Deputy Superintendent / Sponsor	Executive authority and barrier removal
CTO	Project and technical leadership
HR Director	Employee process and access considerations

Coalition Member	Contribution
Communications Director	Consistent messages and leadership talking points
Principal representatives	Campus reality and local influence
Help Desk Manager	Support capacity and user feedback
Instructional Technology Lead	Training and adoption support
Systems / Infrastructure Manager	Technical execution and monitoring

3. Form a Strategic Vision and Initiatives

Vision: Every Ardent ISD staff member can securely access district systems using a consistent authentication process that is understandable, supportable, and sustainable.

Initiatives:

- Protect privileged accounts first.
- Pilot before districtwide enforcement.
- Provide multiple approved authentication methods.
- Make support and recovery predictable.
- Measure adoption and support demand.
- Integrate MFA into ongoing onboarding and account governance.

4. Enlist a Volunteer Army / Communicate the Vision

- Use principals and pilot users as credible messengers.
- Share short demonstrations rather than long technical explanations.
- Repeat the same core message across email, staff portal, meetings, and campus support sessions.
- Give local leaders a dashboard so they can act, not simply forward reminders.

5. Enable Action by Removing Barriers

Barrier	Removal Strategy
No suitable personal device	Approved hardware token / alternate factor

Barrier	Removal Strategy
Shift schedule limits setup time	On-site enrollment windows
Legacy application limitation	Early testing, documented exception, compensating control
Confusing recovery process	One verification script and escalation path
Perception that MFA is optional	Sponsor and principal reinforcement; clear enforcement date

6. Generate Short-Term Wins

Planned wins:

- 100% privileged accounts protected by November 15.
- Pilot campuses reach at least 95% voluntary enrollment before enforcement.
- First campus completes enrollment with fewer support tickets than projected.
- Positive pilot testimonials used in later staff messages.

Rule: Celebrate the outcome and the people who made it possible; do not declare the whole project complete after the first technical milestone.

7. Sustain Acceleration

- Use pilot lessons to improve instructions before each next wave.
- Review unresolved exceptions weekly.
- Continue campus progress reports until completion is stable.
- Use ticket data to identify where communications or training are still weak.
- Avoid adding unrelated identity projects unless the sponsor approves scope change.

8. Institute Change

MFA becomes part of normal operations when:

- New employees enroll during onboarding.
- Privileged access requires MFA by standard.
- Vendor access requirements reference the authentication standard.
- Exceptions are reviewed on a schedule.
- Account-recovery procedures are documented and trained.

- Leadership reporting includes identity-security adoption and exception measures.

Sustainability Measures

Measure	Target	Review Frequency	Owner
Active staff protected by MFA	100%	Monthly	Systems
Approved exceptions	<3% and declining	Monthly	CTO
New hires enrolled before full access	100%	Monthly	HR + Systems
MFA-related help desk tickets	<5% of weekly volume after stabilization	Weekly then monthly	Help Desk
Exception age	No unreviewed exception >90 days	Monthly	Infrastructure Manager

TCEA Technology/IT Director Certification - Module 8: Project Management and Change Leadership - Sample artifact for adaptation.